

The cloud is the limit, bandwidth no bar

We see the silver lining, and it is approaching us, as we glide

We have, not very long ago, been using email accounts that restricted us to 5MB of storage. Yes, 5 MB! Back then, 20 MB seemed like a lot. Wow, we didn't have to delete our emails anymore. Then back in 2004, Gmail stepped in and life wasn't the same. We're talking GBs now. Soon we found ourselves trusting our email service. We were being pampered all this while, because we were getting this for free.

It all began for free!

Edit photos on Picassa, documents and spreadsheets on Google Docs – you name it, we were using it. Thanks to Google, we began accepting our data in alien hands. Probably the reason was we didn't view Google as alien anyway. What followed was a slew of services that claimed to do everything on the 'Cloud'.

Today, we've begun to adapt to services such as Dropbox. A no-nonsense service, you just install it on your computer and access your files from any remote system. It allows you to sync in real time. These are GBs of space with real time sync for free! Even Microsoft's Live SkyDrive and Mesh services allow you to sync upto 5GB of data in real time. Why would anyone need flash drives anymore? With smoother integration of MS Excel, Word and PowerPoint, you wouldn't need Office installed on your system.

We would soon be willing to pay!

But that's about it. What better could we look forward to? What would be innovative in this space? Well in our daily use of technology, we have been witnessing the Cloud.

IPV4 NO MORE

All through the Internet's history, IPv4 and its 32-bit address scheme has largely been the de facto standard to uniquely identify any device on the Web. Later this year, the Internet and connected world is set to officially run out of IPv4 addresses, sparking a mass migration to IPv6 addresses. In India, ISPs and telecom providers are expected to offer only IPv6 addresses after March 2012.

Just that we didn't realise it. BlackBerry Protect is the simplest example. All your data is securely backed up as per your schedule. In case you lose or change your BlackBerry device, all you need to do is register the device and your data is with you at the snap of your fingers. Look at Ubuntu Cloud One. If you move across systems at work and home, you still have access to your personal files! A free OS, with free backup. Isn't that a good deal? Apple lets you back up your data on the cloud too. You'd definitely have heard of iCloud. All your data seamlessly synced on the cloud, accessible from a Mac, Macbook, iPad, iPod or iPhone!

Last month, openSUSE had announced 12.1 which has seamless mirall and ownCloud integration. What's unique about ownCloud is that your data is still under your control. You can host your data on "your" computer and access it from a closed/private network of computers. The concept is not new, but the implementation is innovative. With openSUSE 12.1, you can access your personal files at work, continue working on office assignments, without having to host it on Novell's servers.

It wouldn't be fair to mention cloud services and not talk about Amazon. It is said that Apple's iCloud services will be based on Amazon's AWS and Microsoft's Azure platform. With a variety of platforms and technologies available to base such active sync and data hosting services, a new type of service known as Gladinet is emerging.

Gladinet Cloud desktop is an innovative concept, where depending on your usage scenario, you could either choose to use Gladinet's Cloud storage space, or even Amazon's S3, Microsoft's Skydrive, Box.net, your personal server with FTP or several



“Consumers will spend more time online, and demand for far better online experiences and their online life will become far more valuable to advertisers, marketers and brands.”

Naresh Gupta, Sr Vice President, Print & Publishing Business Unit & Managing Director, Adobe India

other platforms out there to maintain your data. Gladinet sits on top of these platforms and manages your files for you.

Also, Adobe's Creative Cloud service announced at Max 2011 would go live in the first half of 2012. Soon, you could work on your computer, and continue working on it from your tablet or mobile device using Adobe's Creative Cloud service.

Understandably, you need stable internet infrastructure. Hopefully, consumer demand would change the scenario with ISPs bucking up and removing last mile hiccups. Soon, enterprises would be nudging service providers to push commercial software on to the cloud and charge consumers for subscription models to curb piracy. In the end, we should be pleased with larger storage spaces on the cloud, unlimited data use plans and dependable infrastructures. **d**

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